PORT67.AI — MASTER BUSINESS PLAN & PROJECT BASELINE

Version: 1.1 (Port67.ai brand confirmed)
Date: 9 November 2026
Status: Working baseline — commercial hypotheses awaiting market validation
Business: Port67.ai (brand selected; port67.ai domain owned; company registration and trademark clearance to be verified)
Geography: UK-based, initially serving UK businesses, with selective overseas B2B sales
Founder visibility: Brand-led, no personal-founder marketing; comply with all identity, employment, company and client disclosure duties

> **Purpose:** This is the single source of truth for building the agency. Treat decisions marked **LOCKED** as agreed strategic parameters; **HYPOTHESIS** items must be validated by customers; **DECISION REQUIRED** items remain open. Maintain a decision log and update versions as evidence changes.

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0. Executive summary

The opportunity

Build a premium, commercially credible AI agency that sells defined B2B projects to customers who have no prior relationship with the founder. The business combines (1) executive dashboards, (2) AI process transformation, and (3) technology explainers. It is not a generic AI chatbot shop, a pure content production agency, or a personal-brand consultancy.

Mission

Port67.ai — Listen First. Build What Matters.

Understand. Automate. Explain. Help ambitious businesses turn data into decisions, routine processes into intelligent workflows, and complex technology into compelling stories.

Strategic goals

1. **Prove cold-market demand quickly** with one paid £5,000–£12,000 project from a genuinely new customer, targeting an initial 45-day test, not promising it.
2. **Validate the complete economics**: delivery effort, external costs, client willingness to pay, payment collection and repeat sales.
3. **Build a sustainable, repeatable business** with a path to recurring managed services, without depending on the founder's name or employer network.
4. **Create an optional corporate exit** at a lower initial personal income than current compensation, subject to runway, legal review and established profitability.
5. **Preserve £200,000 gross annual personal remuneration as a long-term aspiration**, not an early resignation condition.

Non-negotiable operating principles — LOCKED

- All three pillars remain in scope; no single pillar has been permanently prioritised over the others.
- Initial project ticket is **£5,000–£12,000**, excluding VAT; larger or smaller work requires an explicit decision.
- The first markets are **non-telecom B2B SaaS, software, AI/cloud/cybersecurity, professional services, specialist engineering/technical companies**, and creative/digital agencies as white-label channels. Exclude direct telecom conflicts initially.
- The founder's name, photograph and corporate profile are not used in public-facing promotion. No fictitious executives, staff, testimonials or client results. AI avatars are clearly presented as virtual presenters, not real people.
- Do not use employer assets, confidential information, customer databases, code, systems, working hours, trade secrets or restricted contacts. Independently review employment contract, outside business approval and IP/conflict terms before external launch.
- No speculative large software platform, permanent hires or major brand spending before sales validation.

- Human approval for external outreach, quotes, commitments, contractual changes, payments and consequential AI-agent actions.

At-a-glance commercial model — HYPOTHESIS

Service	Starter offer	Launch price target	Recurring extension
Executive Intelligence Dashboard	Executive KPI dashboard from up to 2–3 *supported, clean* data sources	£8,000	Managed reporting, monitoring and minor improvements £750–£2,000/mo
AI Process Transformation	One contained business workflow with integrations and human approval	£10,000	Monitoring, fixes and optimisation £1,000–£2,500/mo
Technology Explainer & Animation	Premium 60–90s SaaS/technology explainer	£6,000	Campaign cutdowns and monthly creative package £1,500–£3,000/mo

Prices are **proposed commercial tests, not verified market averages**. Clarify what is included, API/platform usage and exclusions before quoting.

Port67.ai brand mandate — CONFIRMED

- **Brand name:** Port67.ai. **Owned domain:** port67.ai.
- **Preferred tagline:** *Listen First. Build What Matters.* (creative direction, subject to final approval).
- **Technical inspiration:** UDP port 67 is used by DHCP servers to listen for and respond to client requests. The metaphor is listening to customers before developing solutions; it is not a claim that port 67 is a generic network listener.
- **Three service pillars: UNDERSTAND** (Executive Intelligence Dashboards), **AUTOMATE** (AI Process Transformation), **EXPLAIN** (Technology Explainers & Animation). All remain equal commercial pillars.
- **Go-to-market:** Brand-led and founder-invisible in public marketing, initially selling £5k–£12k projects to unrelated, non-telecom B2B companies. No invented team members or disguised AI personas.
- **Public identity limits:** The founder may be absent from marketing, but legal ownership, director and customer disclosures must remain accurate. Existing employment obligations must be reviewed.
- **Domain ownership is not trademark clearance:** Check registrations and use before committing to final visual identity.

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1. Business strategy and positioning (WS-01)

Target audience

Primary buying roles: CEOs/founders, operations directors, CFO/finance leaders, heads of sales/revenue operations, product marketing leaders, marketing directors and product heads.

Initial ideal customer profile (ICP): - UK or English-speaking B2B businesses with roughly 10–250 staff; sufficient budget and operational complexity. - Visible business pain: fragmented reporting, recurring manual work, or a complex offering customers struggle to understand. - A decision-maker and a clearly defined project owner. - Evidence of urgency: product launch, new senior hire, strategic initiative, investment round, scaling reporting needs, or a manual process causing real cost. - No apparent conflict with current employment or restrictive covenants.

Positioning

Homepage line: *Understand. Automate. Explain.*
Promise: *Intelligent dashboards, carefully engineered AI automation, and premium technology storytelling — delivered as defined projects for ambitious businesses.*

Avoid implying proprietary models, a large staff, global coverage or certifications that do not exist. Position around tangible deliverables and quality assurance.

Competitive alternatives

1. Generalist AI automation consultants (often low pricing, limited creative expertise).
2. Business intelligence freelancers and Power BI consultancies.
3. Traditional explainer/motion design studios.
4. Internal teams using self-service AI tools.
5. Agencies selling bundled marketing services.

Differentiation to test: one studio blending commercial problem framing, high-end visual communication and usable working systems, without overclaiming expertise.

Key decisions

- **LOCKED:** One business brand and three distinct service landing pages.
- **LOCKED:** Port67.ai is the agency brand and port67.ai is the domain owned by the founder. **OPEN:** visual system, trademark clearance, legal company name, primary industry sub-niche, preferred technology stack and founder's acceptable public legal footprint.
- **HYPOTHESIS:** The three pillars cross-sell and improve retention; measure rather than assume.

Deliverables: positioning brief; ICP scoring rubric; competitor matrix; service-level UVPs; Port67.ai trademark/company-name clearance checklist.

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2. Business structure, legal, risk and operations (WS-02)

Pre-launch order of work

1. Privately obtain specialist UK advice about current employment contract, outside commercial activity, director roles, IP ownership, non-compete/non-solicit obligations, and whether any notice/approval is required. No concealment where legally or contractually prohibited.
2. Decide legal structure with accountant/solicitor. A UK limited company may suit B2B contracts, but directors and people with significant control (PSC) have public disclosure obligations. A brand-first website does not provide anonymous ownership.
3. The port67.ai domain is already owned. Check Port67.ai trademark clearance, Companies House name availability and appropriate legal company name before registration.
4. Choose a professional service/registered-office address (not a substitute for truthful disclosures).
5. Register company, verify relevant identities, set up business banking, bookkeeping, tax calendar and invoice templates if legally appropriate.
6. Acquire professional indemnity and appropriate cyber/public liability cover based on work performed.
7. Prepare standard MSA, statement of work, NDA, data-processing agreement, privacy notice, terms, IP assignment/rights, acceptance policy, change requests, cancellation and support SLAs.
8. Define secure storage, MFA, least privilege, access log, data retention, deletion and customer consent procedures.

Current UK reference points (check again at implementation)

- Online Companies House incorporation fee: **£100** (GOV.UK, checked November 2026).
- VAT registration threshold: **£90,000** taxable turnover in a rolling 12-month period under current published rules.

- Corporation tax rates: 19% small-profits rate and 25% main rate, with marginal relief/other conditions in between. Accountant to model owner salary/dividend and contractor structure.
- B2B email: ICO explains that PECR email-consent requirements differ for corporate versus individual subscribers, but UK GDPR can still apply to named business contacts; sender identity, transparency and opt-out must be handled appropriately.

Primary sources: - https://www.gov.uk/limited-company-formation/register-your-company - https://www.gov.uk/governmen 2026-overview-of-tax-legislation-and-rates-ootlar/annex-a-rates-and-allowances - https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/direct-marketing-and-privacy-and-electronic-communications/business-to-business-marketing/

Brand privacy policy

- No founder bio, photograph, speaking videos or personal social profile linking on agency pages.
- Real company contact, accurately stated legal information, and human accountability on contracts.
- Use an authorised real business representative on client calls when necessary; do not pass an avatar off as a real employee.
- Company registrations, beneficial ownership rules, payment verification, platform administrators and professional contacts may reveal identity. No anonymity guarantee.

Deliverables: legal review checklist; entity decision; financial administration checklist; contracts inventory; risk register; security baseline; supplier/client data map.

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3. Service pillar A — Executive Intelligence Dashboards (WS-03)

Customer problem

Leadership teams make decisions from disconnected spreadsheets, CRM reports, manual PowerPoint packs and lagging metrics.

Productised £8,000 pilot — HYPOTHESIS

Included: discovery workshop; KPI dictionary; up to 2–3 supported clean data sources; responsive executive overview; 3–5 core dashboard views; scheduled refresh; basic access controls; user acceptance test; handover recording; short post-launch support window.

Excluded unless quoted: major data cleansing, bespoke ETL, complex permissions, enterprise SSO, regulated data, unlimited users or data volume, predictive promises, new production data warehouse, extensive custom UI, ongoing platform subscriptions.

Example buyers and use cases

- SaaS CEO: MRR/ARR, churn, acquisition, pipeline and burn visibility.
- Agency principal: utilisation, project margin and pipeline.
- Professional services COO: delivery SLA, workload and backlog.

Portfolio demo

Create a fictional SaaS company **Northstar Analytics** (placeholder, not an actual client): synthetic CRM, billing and product analytics data; executive KPI dashboard; trends, segmentation, drill-down; automated plain-language weekly briefing with source links and caveats.

Production workflow

Discovery → data audit → metrics definition → security/architecture decision → design prototype → connectors → validation with customer → deployment → support agreement.

Acceptance tests

Figures reconcile to sample source records; refresh succeeds or alerts; user rights tested; source provenance visible; errors and missing data flagged; exports correct.

Recurring upsell

Managed reporting, monitoring, source maintenance, weekly executive summaries, new KPI releases. Do not promise strategic accuracy of AI-generated analysis without review.

KPIs: qualified dashboard enquiries; proposals; win rate; average price; delivery days; gross margin; data-quality defects; monthly recurring support revenue.

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4. Service pillar B — AI Process Transformation (WS-04)

Customer problem

Teams manually rekey information, route documents, update CRM or create recurring reports across several business tools.

Productised £10,000 pilot — HYPOTHESIS

Included: process discovery and baseline; one business workflow; 1–3 manageable integrations; defined triggers and outputs; AI interpretation where appropriate; approval checkpoints; exception handling; logs; test plan; admin runbook; 30-day defect warranty for agreed scope.

Excluded unless quoted: mission-critical autonomous decisions, payments, unapproved external messages, regulated legal/medical decisions, unbounded API calls, enterprise-scale integrations, unsupported or locked-down client platforms.

Portfolio demo

Fictional service business **Meridian Operations**: inbound enquiry → document extraction → structured classification → CRM record → human-approved response draft → dashboard and exception queue. Use synthetic data only.

Delivery controls

Require human confirmation for external communications, price commitments, payment-related actions, sensitive record changes and destructive changes. Maintain auditable logs, idempotency, retries, manual fallback and kill switch.

Opportunity ROI worksheet

Document baseline hours/week, fully loaded labour cost, error/rework rate, current system costs, proposed processing costs, setup and support costs, expected savings range, and payback period. No invented savings.

Recurring upsell

Workflow health monitoring, error triage, controlled enhancements, model/tool cost optimisation and compliance checks.

KPIs: hours reduced (verified), exception frequency, successful automation runs, human override rate, platform spend, delivery margin, support load, renewals.

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5. Service pillar C — Technology Explainers & Animation (WS-05)

Customer problem

B2B software and technology firms struggle to describe differentiated value, product features and complex concepts succinctly.

Productised £6,000 pilot — HYPOTHESIS

Included: 60–90 second explainer; discovery interview; script (up to 2 rounds); storyboard/styleframes; animation; commercially licensed narration/music; one master aspect ratio; two consolidated revision rounds; final video delivery.

Excluded unless quoted: new live-action filming, unlimited iterations, multiple languages, extensive character animation, high-end bespoke 3D simulations, voice cloning, unlicensed third-party IP, multiple aspect ratios/versions.

Portfolio demo

Fictional SaaS platform **FlowPilot** (placeholder; clear 'concept demonstration' label): complex approvals and handoffs → unified automated workflow → dashboard showing visibility. Produce a 60-second polished master, 15-second cutdown, storyboard and behind-the-scenes process walkthrough.

Creative quality gates

Message strategy signed off → script approved → storyboard approved → animatic → first cut → legal/technical accuracy pass → final delivery. Clearly label virtual presenters and license all imagery/audio.

Recurring upsell

Monthly product-release animations, content repurposing, launch packs and product training content, with delivery caps.

KPIs: demo-to-meeting rate; average selling price; revision rounds; production days; gross margin; client rebooking; rights clearance completeness.

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6. Brand, website and portfolio (WS-06)

Brand principles

Premium, clean, confident, modern, technology-credible. Avoid generic purple gradients, sci-fi overload, fake staff photos, exaggerated claims and templated AI visuals. The site should show work above the fold.

Proposed sitemap

- Home — "Understand. Automate. Explain." + flagship reel and service cards.
- Intelligence — pain, demo, delivery method, sample scope, starting price, enquiry CTA.
- Automation — before/after workflow, measurable ROI method, controls, starting price, CTA.
- Explainers — showreel, storyboard-to-finished-video example, package detail, CTA.
- Work — three **clearly labelled conceptual demonstrations**, then real permissioned case studies.
- Process — discover, scope, create/build, validate, hand over.
- Contact/Book a Project — qualifying form; genuine human follow-up.
- Privacy/Terms/Company information — proper disclosures.

Credibility stack without public founder

- Exceptional, demonstrably real deliverables.
- Transparent project process, pricing starting points and delivery stages.
- Accurate company details and responsive contact.
- Security and quality assurances that are actually implemented.

- Genuine client testimonials only after permission is obtained.
- Portfolio walkthroughs with narration or clearly identified avatars, not fake spokespeople.

Website conversion measurement

Visits by source, demo plays, 50%/90% video watches, inquiry submissions, qualified inquiries, meetings booked, proposal conversion and revenue by pillar. Privacy-aware analytics and consent handling.

Deliverables: name/visual direction; website copy; design system; landing pages; demo briefs and demo assets; analytics plan; enquiry form.

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7. Marketing and go-to-market by pillar (WS-07)

Common acquisition stance

Brand-led, not founder-led. All outreach to customers with no existing relationship. No employer/customer list crossover. Targeted, compliant, respectful B2B outreach; no mass spam or fake LinkedIn accounts.

Segmented marketing playbooks

Pillar	ICP / buyer	Trigger signal	Message	Proof asset	CTA
Dashboard	SaaS founder, COO, finance, RevOps	Manual board packs; fragmented KPIs; growth	"See the whole business without assembling spreadsheets"	Live synthetic SaaS dashboard demo	20-minute reporting audit
Automation	Ops leader, founder, head of service	Manual handoffs; document backlog; hiring pressure	"Automate one measurable workflow, with controls"	Human-in-the-loop workflow demo + ROI sheet	Workflow diagnostic
Explain	SaaS CMO, product marketer, founder	Product launch, funding, complex website, new category	"Make your software obvious in 60 seconds"	Cinematic product explainer demo	Briefing and creative estimate

Channels and experiments

1. **Targeted outbound email (primary early experiment):** research 100 qualified corporate prospects in batches, verify fit, send low-volume personalised notes, track opt-outs and replies. No autonomous send without approval.
2. **Agency partnerships:** approach 10–20 creative/digital consultancies that may white-label explainer/automation/dashboard production; set partner margin and delivery boundaries.
3. **Brand LinkedIn company page:** publish demos, short how-it-works clips and educational walkthroughs; use legitimate member administration, no fake individual profile.
4. **Search/inbound:** niche landing pages for "SaaS explainer video", "executive reporting dashboard for SaaS", "AI workflow automation for professional services"; build proof and case studies over time.
5. **Selective paid search:** only after landing page and sales conversion evidence. Avoid uncontrolled ad spend.

Example first 100-account segmentation — HYPOTHESIS

- 35 SaaS/software prospects: dashboards and explainers.
- 25 AI/cloud/cybersecurity firms: explainers and controlled workflows.
- 20 professional/specialist services firms: dashboards and automation.
- 20 digital/creative agencies: white-label partner channel.

Funnel tracking

Prospect → researched → approved to contact → contacted → responded → qualified discovery → proposal → verbal agreement → contract/deposit → delivery → testimonial → retainer. Track source, segment, pillar, deal size, close date, objections and time cost.

First experiment targets (not predictions)

Within 45 days: 100 researched accounts, 5–8 qualified conversations, 3 proposals, 1 paid £5k–£12k contract. Review results by segment and pillar; pivot after evidence, not assumptions.

Deliverables: ICP lists, qualification rubric, outreach scripts, customer discovery guide, proposal deck, sample SOW, partnership pitch, campaign dashboard, weekly review cadence.

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8. AI-agent operating system (WS-08)

Principle: Automate repeatable internal work while retaining human accountability and respecting platform and data permissions. Every agent has a trigger, approved tools, input/output schema, validation, human review, logging and failure mode. Start as semi-automated assistants, not uncontrolled autonomous agents.

Agent catalogue and rollout order

ID	Agent	What it does	Inputs	Outputs	Human gate	Phase
AG-01	Market Research	Identify and classify public-company prospects	ICP and public company data	scored lead research brief with sources	approve list before use	P1
AG-02	Prospect Personalisation	Draft useful, relevant outreach	approved prospect brief, service offer	outreach draft + rationale	approve every send	P1
AG-03	Content Studio	Turn project demos into company-branded posts	approved demos and brand guide	draft post, captions, snippets	editorial approval	P1
AG-04	Discovery & Scope	Convert notes into scope and risks	permitted meeting notes, requirements	discovery summary, questions, draft SOW	commercial review	P1
AG-05	Proposal & Pricing	Estimate effort and build proposal	approved scope, rate card, cost assumptions	quote, milestone plan, margin estimate	founder approval	P1
AG-06	Delivery Coordinator	Maintain task status and deadlines	project plan, approved tasks	milestones, status updates, reminders	release approval	P2
AG-07	Quality Assurance	Evaluate deliverables against acceptance criteria	test cases, rendered outputs, dashboard data	QA report, discrepancies	human sign-off	P2

ID	Agent	What it does	Inputs	Outputs	Human gate	Phase
AG-08	Customer Reporting	Create periodic client reports	approved metric dataset	draft weekly/monthly briefing	factual review	P2
AG-09	Finance Controller	Track usage, project costs, invoices and runway	billing exports, timesheets, cash data	margin report, AR list, 13-week cash view	no autonomous payments	P2
AG-10	Account Growth	Flag justified renewals or new opportunities	account history, service metrics	renewal alerts, upsell suggestions	founder decides	P3

MVP stack — choose, don't overbuild

- CRM: lightweight HubSpot or equivalent.
- Automation/orchestration: Make, n8n or Zapier after tool/security assessment.
- Central work tracker: Notion, Linear or similar.
- Knowledge base: versioned Markdown/docs + brand, contracts and proposal templates.
- File storage: client-separated folders with access control.
- Model providers: approved LLM(s) selected by task, cost and data terms.
- Monitoring: error alerts, audit log, token/API spend and approval outcomes.

Safe execution architecture

1. Trigger receives prospect or project event.
2. Agent reads only permitted/necessary data.
3. Model generates structured draft with confidence/uncertainty flags.
4. Rules and QA validate fields, sources, pricing and permissions.
5. Human approves external-facing action.
6. System executes with identity, timestamps and audit trail.
7. Failures alert, retry within limits, or revert to manual processing.

Security prohibitions

Never auto-send cold emails without human review; never invent contact details or testimonials; never use employer material; never grant agents unrestricted financial transactions; never upload confidential customer data to unapproved AI tools; never claim legal or financial compliance solely because an LLM checked it.

Agent success measurements

Minutes saved per week, accuracy, percentage approved unchanged, error rate, cost per task, sales meetings assisted, campaign quality, production defects, time from enquiry to proposal. An agent is retired if maintaining it costs more than its value.

Deliverables: agent registry, permissions matrix, prompts/specifications, integration map, approval screens, cost ledger, security test plan.

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9. Sales, contracting and customer delivery system (WS-09)

Standard commercial process

Inbound/outbound lead → qualification → 20–30-minute discovery → paid diagnostic if genuinely needed → fixed-scope proposal → agreement/deposit → kickoff → milestones → QA/acceptance → invoice/collection → support handover → retainer review.

Deal qualification score (0–2 each; 10 maximum)

Budget confirmed; identifiable decision-maker; genuine business pain; urgency/launch date; realistic scope/data access. Prioritise 8–10, nurture 5–7, decline below 5 unless strategic.

Quote discipline

- 50% deposit for eligible fixed-scope projects, balance at agreed acceptance or milestones; tailor to procurement terms.
- Price separately for source cleanup, extra revisions, additional integrations, paid licences and API usage.
- Include assumptions, dependencies, client responsibilities, change control, warranty, data protection, IP and acceptance.
- Minimum target **gross project contribution margin 60–70%** before fixed overheads and founder time, to be verified with actual delivery data.
- Track founder hours explicitly even if not paid initially; a project that only works through unlimited unpaid founder time is not scalable.

Operational scorecard

Lead-to-meeting conversion; meeting-to-proposal; win rate; average contract value; days to close; project gross margin; delivery days; payment aging; satisfaction; retainer attach rate; concentration and capacity.

Deliverables: CRM stages, discovery templates, proposal calculator, SOW template, delivery project template, post-project review, customer success process.

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10. Finance, capital and remuneration (WS-10)

Capital policy

Initial 45-day validation spend cap **£1,500–£2,500** for brand/site, demo tools, email/CRM and modest marketing, excluding any necessary legal advice, incorporation, insurance and material project costs. Fund further investment through deposits where possible. Avoid offices and permanent payroll before demand proof.

Project unit economics — illustrative only

Project	Selling price	Variable delivery at 25%	Contribution before founder time/overheads
Dashboard	£8,000	£2,000	£6,000
Automation	£10,000	£2,500	£7,500
Explainer	£6,000	£1,500	£4,500

Actual direct costs may be much higher when data is messy, software is complex or cinematic quality demands specialists. Record hours and all tool/API spend by engagement.

Illustrative monthly business cases (not forecasts)

Assume 25% variable delivery cost and £2,000 fixed monthly operating costs; before founder remuneration, corporation tax, VAT, and additional reserves. | Monthly sales | Revenue | Pre-founder operating result | |—|—:|—:| | One £8k project | £8,000 | £4,000 | | Two £8k projects | £16,000 | £10,000 | | Two £8k projects + two £1.5k retainers | £19,000 | £12,250 | | £24k blend of three projects | £24,000 | £16,000 |

Finance controls

- Three separate views: **booked revenue**, **recognised revenue**, and **cash received**.
- Weekly receivables review and rolling 13-week cash forecast.
- Maintain VAT, corporation tax and payroll tax provisions as appropriate.

- Track project-level time, contractor costs, software costs and gross contribution.
- Do not describe pre-founder operating result as personal salary or take-home pay.
- Accountant to model salary/dividends, employer NI, corporation tax, pensions, employment income overlap and VAT.

Long-term remuneration

£200,000 gross annual personal income remains a distant goal. The initial exit case may use a substantially lower personal income, **to be selected based on essential spending, family cash buffer and risk tolerance**.

Deliverables: pricing calculator, 13-week cash flow, rolling P&L, invoicing templates, monthly metrics, owner-income sensitivity model.

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11. People, suppliers and capacity (WS-11)

Operating model

Founder: sales strategy, client discovery, solution architecture, creative direction and QA. Contract freelancers: motion design, frontend/BI, automation engineering, narration/audio, delivery support. Hire permanent staff only when profitable demand is repeatable.

Supplier screening

Portfolio quality, references, test assignment, NDA/IP rights, availability, cost structure, data/security practices, responsiveness, work-for-hire terms and backup capacity.

Capacity planning

Estimate each project in hours by discovery, scripting/design, engineering/animation, QA, handover and revisions. Include customer feedback delays. Never book more delivery than available after current employment commitments and administrative duties.

Scaling gates

- £0–£10k/mo: founder-led + specialists as needed.
- £10k–£20k/mo: two vetted regular subcontractors.
- £20k–£35k/mo: fractional project coordination and specialist capacity.
- £35k+/mo: evaluate stable contracted capacity and stronger QA/account management.

Deliverables: supplier roster, NDA/contract kit, capacity template, delivery-cost benchmarks, QA coverage, backup provider list.

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12. Corporate exit and personal risk (WS-12)

Principle

Build a **strong option to leave** rather than a fixed resignation date. The founder is willing to accept lower take-home income initially, but not indefinite unprofitable trading.

Three gates

Gate A — Market proof: 2–3 unrelated customers have paid target project fees, projects have been successfully delivered, and gross margins are evidenced. Continue employment while testing.

Gate B — Early exit eligible (conditional): several months of repeatable revenue, plausible £15k–£20k/mo run rate, true founder income after taxes sufficient for selected personal minimum, reliable cash collection, active pipeline and delivery support. No automatic resignation.

Gate C — Sustainable transition: personal buffer covering at least 6–12 months of essential expenditure (set based on household circumstances); agency cash covering committed operating costs and tax; known employment compliance position; client concentration controlled; repeat or recurring work; at least 90 days of good-quality contracted/pipeline visibility.

Explicit open decision

DECISION REQUIRED: Minimum acceptable monthly **net personal draw** during years 1–2. This is distinct from the long-term £200k gross remuneration aspiration. Build accountant-reviewed scenarios once selected.

Red flags

More than 30% revenue from one customer, gross margins below target, delayed receivables, founder permanently working beyond sustainable hours, insecure data handling, no approved contracting framework, unresolved employment restriction, or sales pipeline consisting only of noncommittal interest.

Deliverables: exit scorecard, monthly founder-risk review, personal cash runway worksheet, contingency plan and scenario calculator.

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13. Integrated launch roadmap: first 90 days (WS-13)

Start reference: 9 November 2026. Dates are adjustable; stage order is more important than speed. No external launch until legal/employment check is complete.

Stage	Window	Deliverables	Exit criterion
0 — De-risk	Days 1–7	employment/legal issue list; initial ICP; service scoping; working name; demo plans	no unresolved stop-sign for marketing
1 — Build proof	Days 8–15	brand skeleton; one polished flagship demo; two lighter pillar walkthroughs; landing page; real inquiry form	portfolio supports commercial pricing
2 — Market test	Days 16–30	40–60 researched prospects; compliant outreach; partner shortlist; discovery system	measurable response and qualified dialogue
3 — Close	Days 31–45	cumulative 100 researched prospects; target 5–8 qualified discussions; 3 proposals; 1 paid contract objective	signed scope and deposit if achieved
4 — Deliver	Days 46–65	deliver first project; cost/time tracking; QA; customer acceptance	demonstrable margin and satisfaction
5 — Repeat	Days 66–90	second prospect cohort; follow-up pipeline; second signed project target; first managed-service proposal	updated ICP, prices and service focus based on data

Weekly founder cadence (suitable alongside employment)

- 1 hour: review pipeline, decisions and risks.
- 2–3 hours: high-quality targeted prospect research and outreach approval.

- 2–3 hours: demo/portfolio and sales material improvement.
- Customer delivery as contracted; reserve protected time and subcontract if necessary.
- 30 minutes: cash, project costing and agent QA review.

Adjust workload to employment obligations and actual availability. Do not use paid-employment time/resources for agency delivery.

90-day targets — hypotheses

- 100 researched and qualified target organisations.
- 5–8 discovery conversations with independent customers.
- 3 commercial proposals.
- 1–2 signed projects at £5k–£12k.
- First delivery cost and margin benchmark.
- At least 1 genuine recurring-service opportunity.

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14. Workstream register and first backlog

ID	Workstream	Priority	Owner	First specific output	Dependency	Status
WS-01	Strategy & positioning	P0	Founder	1-page positioning + ICP scorecard	none	Not started
WS-02	Legal, structure & risk	P0	Founder + advisers	employment conflict/identity review	none	Not started
WS-03	Dashboard offer	P1	Founder	scope, prototype brief, acceptance checklist	WS-01	Not started
WS-04	Automation offer	P1	Founder	workflow demo spec and safety gates	WS-01	Not started
WS-05	Explainer offer	P1	Founder	storyboard and 60s demo brief	WS-01	Not started
WS-06	Brand, website & portfolio	P1	Founder / contractors	1-page website + portfolio reel	WS-01, WS-02	Not started
WS-07	Marketing & acquisition	P1	Founder + agents	100-account segmented prospect experiment	WS-01, WS-02, WS-06	Not started
WS-08	AI agent operations	P1 → P2	Founder	AG-01/02/03 supervised MVPs	WS-02, WS-07	Not started
WS-09	Sales & delivery operations	P1	Founder	discovery template, proposal and SOW	WS-02, WS-03/04/05	Not started

ID	Workstream	Priority	Owner	First specific output	Dependency	Status
WS-10	Finance & pricing	P0	Founder + accountant	unit economics and 13-week cash model	WS-02	Not started
WS-11	Partners & capacity	P2	Founder	vetted supplier shortlist	WS-03/04/05	Not started
WS-12	Exit decision	P2	Founder + advisers	net income floor and decision scorecard	WS-10	Not started
WS-13	Programme management	P0	Founder	weekly review and decision log	all	Not started

Definition of done for every workstream

1. Output is stored and versioned in the project.
2. Owner, scope, assumptions and decisions are explicit.
3. Legal/security/quality dependencies considered.
4. Commercial impact or success metric documented.
5. Next action and evidence required to advance are stated.

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15. AI Project workspace structure

Suggested project name: **AI Agency — Build & Validate**

```
AI Agency - Build & Validate/
  00_Master_Plan/
    AI_Agency_Master_Business_Plan_v1.md
    Project_Instructions.md
    Decision_Log.md
    Weekly_Status.md
  01_Strategy_and_Brand/
  02_Company_Setup_Legal_and_Risk/
  03_Service_Dashboards/
  04_Service_Process_Transformation/
  05_Service_Technology_Explainers/
  06_Website_Portfolio/
  07_Marketing_and_Lead_Generation/
  08_AI_Agents_and_Automation/
  09_Sales_Contracts_and_Delivery/
  10_Finance_and_Pricing/
  11_Partners_and_Capacity/
  12_Exit_Planning/
  13_Weekly_Reviews/
```

Project working protocol

- At the start of a workstream, cite its ID and reproduce the relevant locked decisions.
- Break it into deliverables, dependencies, tasks, acceptance criteria and a 7-day action plan.
- Never silently change pricing, customer segment, founder visibility, or three-pillar architecture.
- Maintain **Decision Log** entries: date, decision, reason, evidence, impact and next review.

- For every generated artifact, add a proposed filename, owner, version and status.
- End weekly reviews with: accomplished, blockers, pipeline, cash, delivery, next five actions, decisions needed.
- Separate **facts verified by evidence**, **estimates**, **hypotheses**, and **decisions**.

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16. Master KPI dashboard

Area	Metric	Frequency	Initial trigger
Sales	qualified new accounts	weekly	under 15/week after prospecting begins → diagnose
Sales	replies, discovery meetings, proposals, signed value	weekly	0 qualified meetings from first 40 relevant contacts → revise messaging
Marketing	demo views, enquiry rate by pillar	weekly	high views but no enquiries → landing page/offer review
Delivery	booked hours, actual hours, gross margin	per project	margin below 60% → review scope, price and tooling
Finance	cash, receivables, tax reserves, 13-week forecast	weekly	projected cash shortfall → pause discretionary spend
Retainers	active MRR, churn, support load	monthly	support effort exceeds cap → rescope
Agents	time saved, error rate, approval rate, cost	monthly	repeat unsafe/unreliable outputs → disable agent
Risk	conflicts, compliance, data and client concentration	monthly	unresolved high-severity item → halt affected activity
Founder	hours, stress, personal exit runway	monthly	unsustainable workload → reduce scope/delegate

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17. Risk register (initial)

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Employer discovers restricted activity / conflict	Unknown	Critical	legal review first; truthful disclosures; no employer data or hours
Public ownership link to founder	High if director/PSC	High	understand Companies House transparency; brand-led marketing, not false anonymity
No cold-market demand at £5k–£12k	Medium	High	rapid multi-pillar offer tests, paid discovery, revised ICP/pricing
Scope creep and underpricing	High early	High	SOW, acceptance tests, revision limits, change orders
Data/security incident	Medium	Critical	DPA, access control, approved data systems, human checks, backups

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Hallucinated AI output / unintended action	Medium	High	structured outputs, source verification, human approval, audit logs
Contractor delays or IP gaps	Medium	Medium/High	backup suppliers, written IP/rights, milestones, QA
Payment delays	Medium	High	deposits, milestones, credit checks where appropriate, forecast
Founder bottleneck	High	High	strict weekly time budget, standardisation, subcontractor bench
Dependence on one platform/model	Medium	Medium	exportable source assets, alternate tools, monitor costs

18. Decisions log — initial record

ID	Date	Decision	State
D-001	2026-11-07	Build a standalone agency with the ambition of replacing corporate income	LOCKED
D-002	2026-11-07	Three equal pillars: executive dashboards, AI process transformation, technology explainers	LOCKED
D-003	2026-11-07	Target £5k–£12k initial projects and validate quickly	LOCKED
D-004	2026-11-07	Founder not featured publicly; brand-led marketing, compliant disclosures	LOCKED
D-005	2026-11-07	Cold-market sales; exclude direct telecoms initially; SaaS/software/tech allowed	LOCKED
D-006	2026-11-07	£200k gross annual founder remuneration is long-term, not early exit minimum	LOCKED
D-007	2026-11-07	Agency name, precise net income floor, legal structure and core tool stack	OPEN
D-008	2026-11-07	45-day sale target and initial prices are experiments	HYPOTHESIS

19. First seven practical actions

1. **Review employment/legal constraints confidentially** before any public outreach or incorporation decision.
2. **Confirm the first narrow test ICP**, using a shortlist of software and non-telecom B2B sectors.
3. **Write one-page scope cards** for each £8k dashboard, £10k automation and £6k explainer offer.
4. **Create three demo briefs**, selecting one as the flagship first build.
5. **Set up a simple financial and sales tracker** with costs, prospects, pipeline and decision log.
6. **Choose a brand direction** and build a one-page customer-facing site and genuine enquiry route.
7. **Run a first approved outreach batch** once legal, brand and portfolio gates are clear; measure response before scaling.

Appendix A. Source and verification notes

This document is an internal commercial plan. Market fit, prices, conversion targets and revenue assumptions are hypotheses, not independently validated forecasts. Legal and tax notes are high-level and need qualified advice.

Checked UK public guidance, November 2026: - Companies House company registration and PSC/identity disclosure: https://www.gov.uk/limited-company-formation/register-your-company - UK published tax rates/allowances (including VAT/corporation tax): https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/budget-2026-overview-of-tax-legislation-and-rates-ootlar/annex-a-rates-and-allowances - ICO B2B marketing, PECR and UK GDPR: https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/direct-marketing-and-privacy-and-electronic-communications/business-to-business-marketing/

Next update trigger: first external customer discussion, confirmed legal structure, substantive pricing evidence, or completed paid project. Change version to v1.1 and log all amendments.